

Sunday, 17 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Drizzle 16° 11°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 14° 8°	MANCHESTER Drizzle 14° 9°	GLASGOW Drizzle 13° 7°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Kemi Badenoch has shared her delight after rapper Nicki Minaj made an unexpected comparison to Margaret Thatcher.

The Business Secretary mentioned she's a fan of Minaj's track 'Starships'. This unique endorsement certainly got people talking.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Police in Swansea uncovered an unexpected hideaway during a raid on a cannabis farm in Uplands.

Officers found a 42-year-old man, Antonjo Kodhelwas, attempting to conceal himself in a cupboard. It seems his hiding spot wasn't quite as effective as he'd hoped.

CRIME · UK
- 3

A new report reveals dozens of parents are struggling after experiencing significant errors with the Child Maintenance Service.

One parent, John Hammond, claims the CMS took a staggering £20,000 he didn't owe. These accounts highlight ongoing issues within the system.

SOCIAL AFFAIRS · UK

What's coming up

1

Reports suggest the Beckhams' financial empire is poised to reach a significant new milestone.

It's understood David and Victoria's combined wealth is now nearing billionaire status. Meanwhile, Oasis are making their debut on a prominent rich list.

CELEBRITY · THIS WEEK

2

Drake fans have a busy week ahead, with the Canadian rapper unexpectedly dropping a triple album.

These new releases follow a recent high-profile dispute with Kendrick Lamar. Listeners will be keen to see if the new music addresses any of the recent drama.

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

3

The recent Eurovision Song Contest is still generating headlines, with questions now being raised about its future.

The competition faced its biggest boycott in 70 years due to the row over Israel's participation. Many are now wondering how this will impact the contest going forward.

TV · ONGOING

On the schedule

1

Manchester City's Jeremy Doku is expected to be a crucial player in their upcoming FA Cup final.

The winger has become a key part of Pep Guardiola's side as they chase another treble. Many will be watching his performance against Chelsea this weekend.

FOOTBALL · UK

2

England's Jude Bellingham continued his impressive form, scoring for Real Madrid in their latest La Liga victory.

While Bellingham found the net, his teammate Kylian Mbappe received a hostile reception from supporters. It's always great to see our English talent shining abroad.

FOOTBALL · EUROPE

3

As the football season draws to a close, BBC Sport is celebrating the enduring appeal of a classic anthem.

They've been chatting with co-creator David Baddiel about 'Three Lions', the song that truly united the nation. It's a fantastic reminder of football's power ahead of summer tournaments.

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**

The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension shows up in resignation rates, particularly for under-35s.

- 2 Brits spend an average of 38 minutes a day deciding what to watch — and 12 of those are spent scrolling Netflix.**

'Watch-paralysis' has its own subreddit. Streamers are quietly experimenting with 'shuffle' buttons that just play something.

- 3 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**

Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.

- 4 Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.**

Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.

- 5 Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**

The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.

- 6 Almost two thirds of us say we've cried at a podcast in the last year — grief, parenting and identity top the list of triggers.**

Researchers reckon it's the intimacy of audio that does it. The figure is even higher for under-30s, 71% of whom admit a recent podcast-induced tear.

- 7 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**

Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 71% of us admit to doing **THIS** in the car when we think no-one is watching. What is it?
ANSWER: SINGING AT THE TOP OF OUR LUNGS, WITH FULL DRAMATIC FACIAL EXPRESSIONS.

Q Asked 'what's the most British thing about your morning?', the number one answer wasn't a cup of tea — it was **THIS**.
ANSWER: APOLOGISING TO SOMEONE WHO WALKED INTO YOU.

TALK TOPIC

- **If you could only listen to one song for the rest of your life, what is it?**
Talk-back: pick one. No 'depends on the mood'. Just one song forever — go.

- **What's the most British thing you've ever done?**
Talk-back: bonus points for the apology, the queue and the cup of tea all in one anecdote.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A goldfish at Bristol Aquarium has been confirmed as the oldest in captivity in the UK after celebrating its 23rd birthday last week. Staff say its secret is a 'strict diet and very calm music'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Scottish brewery has begun training rescue dogs to detect over-fermented kegs by scent, with the lead beagle reportedly never wrong in six months.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£80 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£80 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Wall of China isn't actually visible from space without aid, despite the myth.
- There are more possible games of chess than atoms in the observable universe.
- A flock of crows is called a 'murder'.
- The unicorn is mentioned in the Bible nine times.
- Coca-Cola would be green if colouring wasn't added to it.
- A day on Venus is longer than a year on Venus.
- Polar bears have black skin under their white fur.
- Hot water freezes faster than cold water under certain conditions — it's called the Mpemba effect.

On this day

Day 137 of the year, 228 days left in 2026. Today Birthday of the Raja (Perlis); Christian feast day: Giulia Salzano; Christian feast day: Blessed Ivan Ziatyk; Christian feast day: Paschal Baylon. Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1955 — Bill Paxton, American actor and director (died 2017)
- 1932 — Rodric Braithwaite, English soldier and diplomat, British Ambassador to Russia
- 1976 — Wang Leehom, American-Taiwanese singer-songwriter, producer, actor, and director
- 1962 — Craig Ferguson, Scottish-American comedian, actor, and talk show host
- 1931 — Dewey Redman, American saxophonist (died 2006)
- 1976 — Kandi Burruss, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1968 — Dave Abbruzzese, American rock drummer and songwriter
- 1974 — Andrea Corr, Irish singer-songwriter, pianist, and actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1992 — Three days of popular protests against the government of Prime Minister of Thailand Suchinda Kraprayoon begin in Bangkok, leading to a military crackdown that results in 52 officially confirmed deaths, hundreds of injuries, many disappearances, and more than 3,500 arrests.
- 1980 — Rioting breaks out in downtown Miami, following the acquittal of four white police officers in the killing of Arthur McDuffie, a Black insurance salesman.
- 1974 — Police in Los Angeles raid the Symbionese Liberation Army's headquarters, killing six members, including Camilla Hall.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1977 — Nolan Bushnell opened the first Chuck E. Cheese's Pizza Time Theatre (later renamed Chuck E. Cheese) in San Jose, California.
- 2000 — Arsenal and Galatasaray fans clash in the 2000 UEFA Cup Final riots in Copenhagen

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1997 — Troops of Laurent-Désiré Kabila march into Kinshasa. Zaire is officially renamed Democratic Republic of the Congo.

- 1983 — The U.S. Department of Energy declassifies documents showing world's largest mercury pollution event in Oak Ridge, Tennessee (ultimately found to be 4.2 million pounds [1.9 kt]), in response to the Appalachian Observer's Freedom of Information Act request.
- 1973 — Watergate scandal: Televised hearings begin in the United States Senate.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 138 of the year, 227 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Ælfgifu of Shaftesbury; Christian feast day: Blessed Blandine Merten; Christian feast day: Eric IX of Sweden; Christian feast day: Felix of Cantalice. Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1949 — Walter Hawkins, American gospel music singer and pastor (died 2010)
- 1958 — Toyah Willcox, English singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1967 — Nancy Juvonen, American screenwriter and producer, co-founded Flower Films
- 1952 — Diane Duane, American author and screenwriter
- 1977 — Lee Hendrie, English footballer
- 1970 — Tina Fey, American actress, producer, and screenwriter
- 1952 — George Strait, American singer, guitarist and producer
- 1975 — Jack Johnson, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1955 — Operation Passage to Freedom, the evacuation of 310,000 Vietnamese civilians, soldiers and non-Vietnamese members of the French Army from communist North Vietnam to South Vietnam following the end of the First Indochina War, ends.
- 2015 — At least 78 people die in a landslide caused by heavy rains in the Colombian town of Salgar.
- 1953 — Jacqueline Cochran becomes the first woman to break the sound barrier.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

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Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		